

Infocom follows a similar model with product division Emblitz and training and development division Eilabz.

Dr Subbarangaiah informs that they follow a teaching-company model with university and industry participation, which is similar to the time-proven teaching-hospital model in medical education. Academic and industry-proven practices go hand in hand. Experienced professionals share their knowledge and expertise as a trainer. Thus a professional executes a dual role. This model has helped during the incubation of quite a few companies with quick ramp-up of teams.

'Short-term' and 'high-frequency' are the buzzwords for revenue generation. For example, currently, Sand-

Institutes should try to increase their reach by upgrading to virtual classroom based programmes.

—Vishwanath Raju, Director-Technical, Vector Embedded Systems

enough to customise their training duration according to the need of the hour. Naveen Kumar, managing director, Emtech Foundation, informs, "We are focused on both skill development (short-term) and career-building programmes (long-term) for engineers in embedded systems."

Diversification is another key to success in this field. "In January this

courses in embedded system and VLSI, including a three-month micro-controller-based course, six-month postgraduate diploma in embedded systems, six-month course in VLSI and system design, three-month course in digital signal processing, and courses in robotics and RTOS. This variety in duration and subject helps to cater to the customers in a better way."

The business strategies may vary from organisation to organisation but the preferred target customers remain the same for all of them. "Engineering students are the most important for us followed by working professionals and corporate clients, respectively," informs Col. N.C. Pande, head, EFY TechCenter.

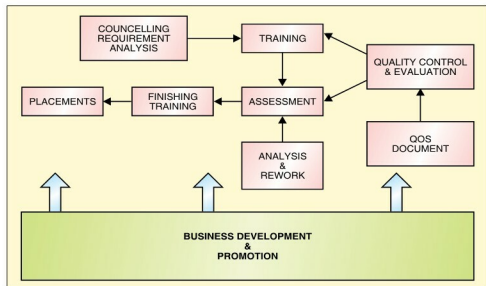
Kalra explains, "We follow a business model which is cost-effective for budding engineers. As far as expectation for 2010 is concerned, there is good potential in the training market for the players who are dedicated to providing quality education on competitive prices."

Organisations are even ready to offer something extra to reach and retain their preferred customer base. "We conduct workshops to generate awareness among budding engineers about the latest emerging trends and the scope in the fields of VLSI and embedded systems," says Sandeep Sreedharan, managing director, Emera Infotech.

Pillai informs, "We have initiated a unique programme under which we offer selective free training to the faculty of engineering colleges in India at their premises. We also guide them to improve their academic standards."

Moving up the value chain

The training industry in India is looked upon more or less as a middleman



Block diagram of the proposed generic business model

eevani School of VLSI System Design has two courses of 10-week duration, one for VLSI and the other embedded. Each of these courses is conducted once a quarter to reach greater number of trainees. Both the courses are intermediate in nature.

Other players too are flexible

year, we had 15 companies for campus placement. The number is likely to go up with the market picking up in areas like telecom applications, automotive embedded systems, industrial automation, chip designing and product-based R&D," says Raju.

Nadh says, "We provide many

Updation of curriculum in accordance with the fast changing demands of the industries is the key to survival.

—Jatinder Singh, CEO, TICO